

BLAMO CLOSING

THE QUALIFYING QUESTIONS GUIDE



The Qualifying Questions Guide

75 questions that uncover why the customer is buying —
not just what they're buying.

How to Use This Guide

“The best salespeople don’t have the best presentation — they ask the best questions. A great qualification process uncovers why the customer is buying, not just what they’re buying.”

HOW TO USE IT

Work one category per shift, top to bottom. Say the questions out loud until they sound like you, and adapt the wording to your market and your voice — the structure matters more than the exact words. Never read from the page in front of a customer. The best question is the one that sounds like you meant it.

THE CURIOSITY RULE

Ask with genuine curiosity, not interrogation. A question is a doorway — the customer’s answer tells you where to go next. Listen more than you talk. The customer is the expert on their own life; your job is to understand it well enough to match the right vehicle to it.

HOW THE 75 ARE ORGANIZED

Seventy-five questions, nine categories, numbered 1 through 75 — from the first hello to the commitment question. The category map on the next page shows the whole arc. When you’re short on time, the Golden 10 distills the system into ten questions, and the sales flow chains six of them into one natural conversation.

THE HONESTY RULE

Never invent a need the customer didn’t express, and never put words in their mouth. Write down what they actually said, present the vehicle that fits what they told you, and let their answers — not your assumptions — carry the presentation.

The Nine Categories

Seventy-five questions, nine categories, one goal: understand why the customer is buying. Work top to bottom — Rapport opens the conversation, Commitment closes it.

1	Building Rapport	The first ten questions do two jobs at once: they put the customer at ease and they start the qualification before the customer even notices. The answers here shape every question that follows.
2	Finding the Main Driver	Know who this vehicle is really for before you present a single car. Selling to the wrong person in the room wastes everyone's time.
3	Discovering Wants vs. Needs	Needs close the deal; wants make it exciting. Separate the two and you'll show the right vehicle and justify the right features.
4	Lifestyle Questions	A vehicle lives in someone's real week — commutes, kids, pets, weekends. These questions let you picture that week and match the vehicle to it.
5	Budget Questions	Money is where deals are won and lost. Ask about payment and trade early, honestly, and without judgment — then you never present numbers blind.
6	Decision Maker Questions	Know who has to say yes before you invest an hour with the wrong person. These questions map the decision before you start closing.
7	Buying Motivation	Why now? The reason they're shopping today is the fuel for the whole deal. Find the motivation and you'll know what to emphasize.
8	Competition Questions	You can't beat a competitor you don't know about. These questions tell you where you stand and what it will take to win.
9	Commitment Questions	Before you present numbers, know how close the customer is. These questions measure the gap between shopping and buying.

1 Building Rapport

WHY IT MATTERS — The first ten questions do two jobs at once: they put the customer at ease and they start the qualification before the customer even notices. The answers here shape every question that follows.

- 1 What brings you in today?
- 2 Is today just the beginning of your search or have you been looking for a while?
- 3 Have we had the pleasure of helping you before?
- 4 How did you hear about us?
- 5 What caught your attention about this vehicle?
- 6 Where are you driving from today?
- 7 What do you do for work?
- 8 What do you drive now?
- 9 How long have you owned it?
- 10 What do you like most about your current vehicle?

2 Finding the Main Driver

WHY IT MATTERS — Know who this vehicle is really for before you present a single car. Selling to the wrong person in the room wastes everyone's time.

- 1 Who will be driving this vehicle most of the time?
- 2 Is this primarily your vehicle or will someone else be using it regularly?
- 3 Does anyone else need to be comfortable with this decision?
- 4 Will this be replacing another vehicle or adding to the household?
- 5 Who usually drives on family trips?

3 Discovering Wants vs. Needs

WHY IT MATTERS — Needs close the deal; wants make it exciting. Separate the two and you'll show the right vehicle and justify the right features.

- 1 What made you decide it's time for a different vehicle?
- 2 What's missing from your current vehicle?
- 3 If you could change one thing about your current car, what would it be?
- 4 What are the three most important things you're looking for?
- 5 What features are must-haves?
- 6 What features would be nice to have?
- 7 Are there any features you absolutely don't want?
- 8 Is fuel economy important?
- 9 How important is reliability?
- 10 Is technology important to you?
- 11 Is safety a top priority?
- 12 How important is resale value?
- 13 Do you tow anything?
- 14 Do you need AWD or 4WD?
- 15 How much cargo space do you need?

4 Lifestyle Questions

WHY IT MATTERS — A vehicle lives in someone's real week — commutes, kids, pets, weekends. These questions let you picture that week and match the vehicle to it.

- 1 Tell me about a typical day with your vehicle.
- 2 What's your daily commute like?
- 3 Do you do a lot of highway driving?
- 4 Do you travel often?
- 5 Do you have children?
- 6 Any pets riding along?
- 7 Do you enjoy camping, boating, or outdoor activities?
- 8 Do you need room for sports equipment?
- 9 How many passengers do you usually carry?
- 10 Do you need third-row seating?

5 Budget Questions

WHY IT MATTERS — Money is where deals are won and lost. Ask about payment and trade early, honestly, and without judgment — then you never present numbers blind.

- 1 Have you already established a comfortable monthly payment?
- 2 Are you more focused on payment or total investment?
- 3 Have you looked into financing yet?
- 4 Will you be putting money down?
- 5 Are you planning to trade your current vehicle?
- 6 Have you checked what it's worth?
- 7 Is there a payment you definitely don't want to exceed?
- 8 Will this purchase be for personal or business use?
- 9 Are you paying cash or financing?
- 10 What would make this purchase feel comfortable financially?

6 Decision Maker Questions

WHY IT MATTERS — Know who has to say yes before you invest an hour with the wrong person. These questions map the decision before you start closing.

- 1 Besides yourself, who else will be involved in making the final decision?
- 2 Does your spouse or partner usually help make vehicle decisions?
- 3 If we find the perfect vehicle today, will everyone needed to make the decision be available?
- 4 Is anyone else planning to see the vehicle before you buy?
- 5 Have you already discussed this purchase together?

7 Buying Motivation

WHY IT MATTERS — Why now? The reason they're shopping today is the fuel for the whole deal. Find the motivation and you'll know what to emphasize.

- 1 Why now?
- 2 What changed that made today the day to start shopping?
- 3 Is your current vehicle giving you problems?
- 4 Are you looking for something newer, safer, or larger?
- 5 Is this purchase more of a want or a need?
- 6 When would you ideally like to have your next vehicle?
- 7 Is there a deadline you're working toward?
- 8 What's motivating you the most to make a change?

8 Competition Questions

WHY IT MATTERS — You can't beat a competitor you don't know about. These questions tell you where you stand and what it will take to win.

- 1 What other vehicles have you looked at?
- 2 What do you like about those?
- 3 What don't you like about them?
- 4 Have you driven any competitors yet?
- 5 What would make you choose us instead?

9 Commitment Questions

WHY IT MATTERS — Before you present numbers, know how close the customer is. These questions measure the gap between shopping and buying.

- 1 If we found the right vehicle today, would you be open to taking it home?
- 2 Is there anything that would keep you from buying today if everything lined up?
- 3 What would have to happen for you to feel great about buying today?
- 4 On a scale of 1-10, how serious are you about purchasing?
- 5 What's the biggest concern you have right now?
- 6 What would make this an easy decision?
- 7 If we exceed your expectations today, are you ready to earn our business?

The Golden 10

If you only asked 10 questions, make them these:

- 1** What brings you in today?
- 2** Why are you replacing your current vehicle?
- 3** Who will be driving it most?
- 4** What are the three most important things you're looking for?
- 5** Which features are absolute must-haves?
- 6** Besides yourself, who will be involved in making the decision?
- 7** Are you planning to trade your current vehicle?
- 8** Are you shopping for a payment, a price, or the right vehicle?
- 9** If we found the perfect vehicle and the numbers made sense, would you be ready to take it home today?
- 10** Is there anything that could prevent us from earning your business today?

Memorize these ten in order — they walk the whole arc: why they came in, what they need, who decides, and what it takes to earn the business. On a busy day, this list alone will carry the conversation from hello to the desk.

A Sales Flow That Works

A simple framework many top automotive sales professionals use is:

REASON → DRIVER → NEEDS → BUDGET → DECISION → COMMITMENT

1 Reason

WHAT IT'S FOR

The first question does more than start the conversation — it tells you why the customer walked in. The reason they give you now is the fuel for the whole deal. Write it down and come back to it at the desk.

THE QUESTION TO ASK

“What brings you in today?”

MORE QUESTIONS TO TRY

- Is today just the beginning of your search or have you been looking for a while?
- Why now?

2 Driver

WHAT IT'S FOR

Before you talk about vehicles, know who this is really for. The decision-maker isn't always the person standing in front of you — and presenting to the wrong person wastes the whole appointment.

THE QUESTION TO ASK

“Who will be driving this vehicle most?”

MORE QUESTIONS TO TRY

- Is this primarily your vehicle or will someone else be using it regularly?
- Does anyone else need to be comfortable with this decision?

3 Needs

WHAT IT'S FOR

This is where the vehicle gets chosen. Separate the must-haves from the nice-to-haves, and you'll know exactly which vehicle to show and which features to point out.

THE QUESTION TO ASK

“What are the three most important things you're looking for?”

MORE QUESTIONS TO TRY

- What's missing from your current vehicle?
- What features are must-haves?

4 Budget

WHAT IT'S FOR

Money isn't a trap question — it's a planning question. Ask it early and without judgment, and you never present numbers blind or waste time on a vehicle that's out of range.

THE QUESTION TO ASK

"Are you more focused on the monthly payment or the total investment?"

MORE QUESTIONS TO TRY

- Have you already established a comfortable monthly payment?
- Is there a payment you definitely don't want to exceed?

5 Decision

WHAT IT'S FOR

Find out who has to say yes before you start closing. If a spouse, a parent, or a business partner needs to approve, you want them in the conversation — or at least prepared for it.

THE QUESTION TO ASK

"Besides yourself, who else will be involved in making the decision?"

MORE QUESTIONS TO TRY

- Does your spouse or partner usually help make vehicle decisions?
- If we find the perfect vehicle today, will everyone needed to make the decision be available?

6 Commitment

WHAT IT'S FOR

Before you present numbers, know how close the customer is. The commitment question isn't a push — it's a temperature check that tells you whether to close, keep building value, or handle one last concern.

THE QUESTION TO ASK

"If we find the right vehicle and the numbers make sense, are you ready to take it home today?"

MORE QUESTIONS TO TRY

- On a scale of 1-10, how serious are you about purchasing?
- What's the biggest concern you have right now?

By the time you present numbers, you should know exactly why they're buying, what problem they're trying to solve, who has to say yes, what they can comfortably afford, and what it will take to earn their business. That's when closing becomes much more natural because you've been guiding the conversation from the start.

Practice Checklist

Qualification is a skill, not a script. Grade yourself after every real conversation — and run a deliberate seven-day plan to make these questions automatic.

GRADE YOURSELF AFTER EVERY CONVERSATION

- ☐ Did you start with rapport and keep the tone of a conversation, not an interview?
- ☐ Do you know the real reason they're buying today — and did you write it down?
- ☐ Do you know who has to say yes before you presented the vehicle?
- ☐ Did you separate must-haves from nice-to-haves and confirm the deal-breakers?
- ☐ Do you know the payment range, the trade plan, and what “comfortable” means to them?
- ☐ Did you ask how close they are — the 1-10 — before presenting numbers?
- ☐ Did you ask for the commitment directly, and listen to what came back?
- ☐ Did you note one question you could have asked better for next time?

7-DAY PRACTICE PLAN

- ☐ Day 1: Learn the Building Rapport category cold — all ten questions in your own words.
- ☐ Day 2: Practice Main Driver and Wants vs. Needs on real conversations.
- ☐ Day 3: Add Lifestyle and Budget questions — ask them early and without judgment.
- ☐ Day 4: Work Decision Maker and Buying Motivation into your process.
- ☐ Day 5: Close conversations with Competition and Commitment questions.
- ☐ Day 6: Run the full six-step flow — Reason through Commitment — on every customer.
- ☐ Day 7: Role-play the Golden 10 with a teammate and grade each other on the checklist.

THE ONLY RULE

Ask with genuine curiosity, not interrogation. The goal is never to trip the customer up — it's to understand them well enough to show the right vehicle, present the right numbers, and earn the right to close.

Quick Reference

Keep this one-pager at the desk. The sales flow carries the conversation; the Golden 10 is the whole system when you only have minutes.

REASON → DRIVER → NEEDS → BUDGET → DECISION → COMMITMENT

REASON	"What brings you in today?"
DRIVER	"Who will be driving this vehicle most?"
NEEDS	"What are the three most important things you're looking for?"
BUDGET	"Are you more focused on the monthly payment or the total investment?"
DECISION	"Besides yourself, who else will be involved in making the decision?"
COMMITMENT	"If we find the right vehicle and the numbers make sense, are you ready to take it home today?"

THE GOLDEN 10

1. What brings you in today?
2. Why are you replacing your current vehicle?
3. Who will be driving it most?
4. What are the three most important things you're looking for?
5. Which features are absolute must-haves?
6. Besides yourself, who will be involved in making the decision?
7. Are you planning to trade your current vehicle?
8. Are you shopping for a payment, a price, or the right vehicle?
9. If we found the perfect vehicle and the numbers made sense, would you be ready to take it home today?
10. Is there anything that could prevent us from earning your business today?

WHERE TO GO NEXT

Explore The Sales Rep Starter Kit for the five core closes, The 10 Steps of the Sale for the in-store floor process, The 10 Steps to the Internet Sale for online leads, The Five Closes in Action for realistic dialogue, and the objection playbooks — Spouse, "Pray About It," and Trade-In. Blamo Closing training is practical, honest, and built for the work in front of you.